LIFT Philly

liftphilly.org

Labor (1099)
Individual Enterprise
Family Enterprise
Tax Reform

Solution-focused, not political. We're all Philadelphians solving a problem together.

The problem is in the system, not individuals. No blame, no shame. The system was designed for a different economy.

Shepherd mindset. Shepherds focus on solutions with love. Be the shepherd when advocating for LIFT. In the room with us? Share your fear, uncertainty, and doubt—we'll help you through it.

The Problem

For 10 years, Philadelphia's smallest businesses had a shield from BIRT (Business Income and Receipts Tax)—letting them start, grow, and support their families. **In 2026, that shield is gone.**

If in **2025** you earned **$50,000** and you are a:

Laborer (1099) | Individual Enterprise | Family Enterprise

Starting in April 2026, your Philadelphia tax bill will increase by:

+$1,208 — +$3,746

That's between 1 and 3 months' rent for many Philadelphians—and they simply can't afford it.

Calculate Yours

liftphilly.org/calculator

85%
of all city businesses

That includes 122,000 Philadelphians who own and operate single-owner entities: contractors, freelancers, gig workers, nurses, barbers, food truck vendors, artists, retailers, and more.

The Solution: The LIFT Act

Pioneering legislation introduced in November 2025 by Councilman Mike Driscoll, the LIFT Act fixes the system instead of patching it by acknowledging a **third tax class that already exists** but is unrecognized by the law.

This class includes Laborers/1099s, and any individual or family enterprises with an individual owner (including those with employees).

Reviewed and confirmed by Philadelphia Law Department. Meets PA Constitution's Uniformity Clause requirements.

What the LIFT Act Enables

- ✓ City Council and the Mayor can legally remove BIRT for the LIFT class completely
- ✓ NPT tax remains, ensuring fair taxation instead of the current double-taxation structure
- ✓ Keeps money in local neighborhoods—every dollar retained turns into $3+ in local spending

Result for an individual or family earning $50K: completely eliminates the surprise tax increase

All single-owner businesses, with or without employees, are included in this class and solution.

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What You Can Do

1 Calculate Your Increase Before Filing

Use the calculator at liftphilly.org/calculator to see your tax increase, then share it with your professional network so they can calculate theirs.

2 Start Conversations

Ask 3-5 solopreneurs you know:

> ***"If you had to pay 1-3 months extra rent in taxes in 2026 and beyond, how would that affect your ability to care for yourself, your family, and your community?"***

Then listen. Report back what you hear.

3 Connect Us

Who in your community is a trusted voice? Formal leaders AND informal networks matter.

4 Identify Testimony Voices

Who would be powerful at a City Council hearing? We need voices from:

- Construction/trades (plumbers, electricians)
- Food/hospitality (food trucks, catering)
- Healthcare (therapists, home health aides)
- Childcare providers
- Transportation/rideshare drivers
- Legal solo practitioners
- Barbers and hair stylists
- Media & journalism
- Creative (music, film, photo)
- Real estate & development
- Fitness & wellness
- Tech & innovation
- Arts & culture
- Reentry/second-chance entrepreneurs

Current Bill Status

- Bill introduced November 20, 2025 by Councilman Mike Driscoll
- Council President drafted bill and provided technical support for Fiscal Analysis
- Multiple council members engaged
- Finance Committee hearings expected: Late January / Early February 2026

Current Timeline

Today: Commit to 1-2 actions from above
Weekly: Check-ins — "Who did you talk to? What did you hear?"
Late Jan/Feb: Fill City Council chambers for hearings